Connie Xu

conniexu@g.harvard.edu
240.429.2307
conniexu75.github.io

HARVARD UNIVERSITY

8 Story St, Suite 380
Cambridge, MA 02138

Placement Director: David Grabowski grabowski@hcp.med.harvard.edu
Placement Director: Haiden Huskamp huskamp@hcp.med.harvard.edu
Administrative Contact: Deborah Whitney deborah_whitney@harvard.edu

Education

Harvard University
Ph.D. Health Policy and Economics, 2021 to 2027 (expected)

University of Chicago
B.A. in Economics (with Honors), 2019
B.A. in Statistics, 2019

Fields

Innovation Economics
Health Economics
Labor Economics

References

Amitabh Chandra (chair) achandra@hbs.edu

Luca Maini maini@hcp.med.harvard.edu

Kyle Myers kmyers@hbs.edu

Fellowships & Awards

NBER Fiscal and Economic Effects of Innovation and Productivity Policies Fellow	2026-2027
Harvard GSAS Dissertation Completion Fellow	2026-2027
National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program	2024-2027
NBER Pre-doctoral Fellowship in Aging & Health	2023-2024
Harvard Kennedy School Distinction in Student Teaching Award	2024
Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality T32 Trainee	2021-2023
Phi Beta Kappa	2019
UChicago Careers in Health Professions Health Policy Scholar	2016-2019

Teaching

Instructor, *Essentials for the Profession Course (Nursing Homes)*, Harvard Medical School	2025
Teaching Fellow, *Empirical Methods II (Econometrics)*, Harvard Kennedy School	2024

Research Assistantships

Graduate Research Assistant to Professor Amitabh Chandra, *Harvard Business School*	2022-2024
Graduate Research Assistant to Professor Timothy Layton, *Harvard Medical School*	2022-2024
Pre-doctoral Research Fellow to Professor Amy Finkelstein, *MIT*	2019-2021
Microeconomics Research Intern, *Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago*	2018

Job Market Paper

Managing the Rising Cost of Science: Supplier Consolidation in the Academic Life Sciences, *with Ruby Zhang*

Many scientific inputs are sold in increasingly concentrated markets that expose scientists to rising prices, while experimental protocols calibrated to specific products make it difficult to substitute away from them. How much science is lost when these inputs become more expensive, and which scientists are better able to adjust? Using purchase-level procurement records, we follow a merger of two large life sciences suppliers from the prices principal investigators (PIs) pay to the research they produce. Post-merger prices in affected markets rose by roughly 20 percent, while quantities declined only temporarily, indicating limited demand response. PIs facing larger increases in their input costs published less. For the average PI, input costs rose by about 2.8 percent and scientific output fell by about 1.2 percent. The consequences of higher input prices therefore extend beyond research costs to the production of science itself. The output losses fall disproportionately on early-career PIs. Financial resources do not explain this difference. Instead, the ability to adjust appears to improve with experience, consistent with PIs accumulating knowledge of how to respond to higher costs through years of running a lab.

Working Papers

Person and Place Effects in Scientific Discovery, *with Amitabh Chandra*

How much of a scientist's research output is attributable to individual talent, and how much to the institution where they work? Because markets systematically under-provide fundamental science, the answer matters for how societies allocate the resources that substitute for missing market incentives, how the scientific community evaluates researchers for promotion and grants, and whether the current distribution of scientists across institutions maximizes knowledge production. We study this question using citation-weighted publications in leading life-science journals and a movers design that exploits variation in the output of nearly 40,000 scientists who change institutions. We find that 50 to 60 percent of the variation in a scientist's research output is attributable to institutional factors. After correcting for limited mobility bias, we document positive assortative matching between scientists and institutions (a correlation of 0.3 between person and place effects), a necessary condition for maximizing aggregate knowledge production under the multiplicative structure of our model. Around two-thirds of the institutional effect is explained by the presence of star researchers. A scientist's output responds to both the total output of their institution and its funding level, but not to the size of the local research cluster, suggesting that institutional effects operate through the human capital environment within an institution rather than through agglomeration or research funding alone. The symmetry of effects for upward and downward movers implies that institutional advantages do not permanently transfer to scientists who leave. These effects have not diminished despite technologies facilitating remote collaboration, are robust to detailed field-by-year controls, and raise the possibility that similar patterns extend to other areas of fundamental science.

Returns to Science of Centrally Provisioned GPUs and Optimal Allocation, *with Ruby Zhang*

Should federal infrastructure funding go to more productive universities or to universities where external funding is most likely to relieve financing constraints? We construct a novel panel of CPU and GPU capacity at U.S. R1 universities from historical research-computing websites and link it to publication and researcher histories from OpenAlex. Exploiting large, discrete capacity expansions in a staggered difference-in-differences design, we find substantial heterogeneity in the impact of upgrades on computer science paper publications. Less-resourced universities experience persistent gains, while effects at well-resourced universities are short-lived. We model the university as a multi-product organization, estimate field-level production elasticities with respect to computing capital and researchers, and use the implied marginal products of capital to evaluate counterfactual funding allocations. In a counterfactual holding fixed all inputs except GPU capital, a purely publication-maximizing allocation concentrates capital funding more heavily at relatively high-output institutions than the observed portfolio from the National Science Foundation (NSF), consistent with the agency valuing a broader distribution of scientific capacity.

The Ripple Effects of Health Care Entry Regulation, *with Yunan Ji and Parker Rogers*

We examine how regulatory entry costs for healthcare inputs shape market structure, pricing, and bargaining dynamics throughout the healthcare supply chain. Using a difference-in-differences approach exploiting the FDA's 2016 removal of pre-market clearance requirements for certain medical devices, we find increased manufacturer entry and lower negotiated device prices between manufacturers and hospitals. These reduced input prices propagate downstream, modestly decreasing procedure prices negotiated with insurers and ultimately lowering patient out-of-pocket costs. We then develop and will estimate a structural model that jointly captures manufacturer entry decisions and simultaneous bargaining between hospitals, manufacturers, and insurers. Our proposed counterfactual simulations will quantify how tightening entry regulations or increasing horizontal consolidation would ripple through the supply chain.

Invited Presentations

European Association for Research in Industrial Economics Conference — 2026
American Society of Health Economists Conference
Wharton Innovation Doctoral Symposium

	NBER Assessing the U.S. Medical Innovation System	2025
	Harvard Seminar in the Economics of Science & Engineering	2024
	NBER Place-Based Policies and Entrepreneurship	
Academic Service	**Referee:** *The Journal of the American Medical Association*	
	Organizer: Harvard Health Care Policy Health Economics Seminar	
	Peer Mentor: Harvard Health Policy PhD Program	
Research Grants	The Lab for Economic Applications and Policy Award, *with Ruby Zhang*	2026-2027
	John and Kiendl Gordon Economics Support Fund, *with Ruby Zhang*	2025-2026
	The Lab for Economic Applications and Policy Award, *with Ruby Zhang*	2024-2025
	NBER Center for Aging and Health Research Pilot Grant, *with Amitabh Chandra and Timothy Layton*	2023-2024
Languages	English (native), Mandarin (fluent)	
Citizenship	United States	